

across the world echoed loudly, because over the course of that single, this was the achievement that stretched cricket's boundaries and made the business of batsmanship even more weighty. In his 16 years of international cricket, Gavaskar had wiped out every batting record, barring Don Bradman's average of 99.94. That day he set his own. By evening, he was out for 63 and they say when he returned to the dressing room, at first he was not satisfied, but furious. Gavaskar's principle never changed: every run counted, every innings had to be maximised. So 10,000 had been achieved but to not extend that innings of 63 irked him. If he ever got out after getting in, dressing rooms would usually clear out to give the infuriated maestro his space. When play ended, what he did have though, was contentment, "I would have just been happy with 1,000 runs. Now I feel 10 times more fantastic." No wonder, even in the dry state of Gujarat that night, they sourced some champagne to go with the cake. India did not know it then but Gavaskar was to play only one more Test after Ahmedabad. When he retired later that year, the country was in deep gloom: Indian cricket's defender, its most gritty general had gone. He had re-defined the standards of excellence and professionalism, re-written definitions in the school of Indian batsmanship. It is said he has no mementos from the match in which he crossed 10,000, but he wouldn't need any: Sunil Gavaskar's achievement always carries with it the power of everlasting memory.

by Sharda Ugra

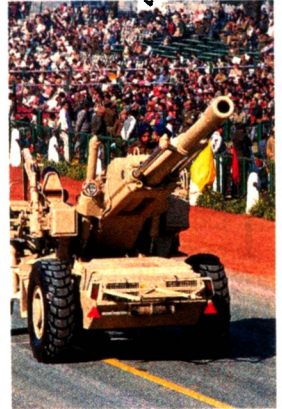
THE MAIN EVENT

The Bofors Scam

When K.C. Pant rose to reply to a six-hour debate on the unending Bofors saga in the Lok Sabha, no one had expected the mild-mannered defence minister to spring a surprise. But in a move that caught the Opposition flat-footed, Pant placed on the table of the House the entire set of 26 letters exchanged between the Government of India, Bofors and the Swedish Government since mid-April. The decision to place the papers was clearly meant to signal the Government's increasing confidence in tiding over the crisis that was precipitated by a Swedish Radio bombshell more than four months earlier. But the letters failed to answer the basic question: who made money in the Rs 1,700 crore Bofors gun deal signed in March 1986?

India Today, September 15, 1987

PRASHANT PANJIAR/ www.indiatodayimages.com



A BOFORS HOWITZER AT THE REPUBLIC DAY PARADE IN 2006

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